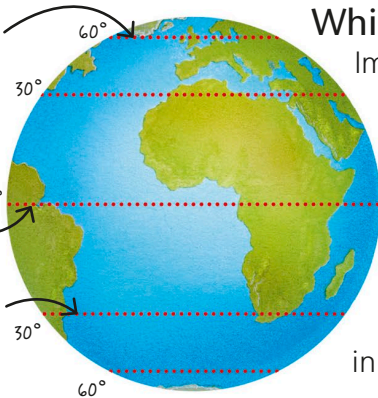


This latitude line is 60° North (of the equator).

The equator is 0° latitude.

This latitude line is 30° South (of the equator)



Which line are you on?

Imaginary lines called latitude lines help us describe where a place is on the Earth's surface. They are counted north or south of the equator and are measured in degrees ($^\circ$). Knowing which latitude line you live on will help you know which stars are in the sky above your home.

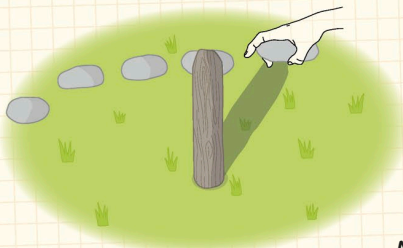
FINDING DIRECTIONS

To study the stars, you'll need to know which direction to look.
Make a compass with a stick and some stones.

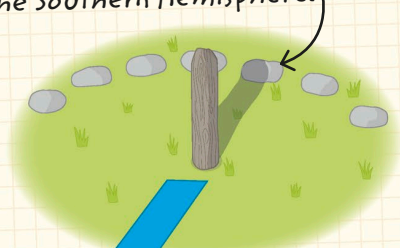
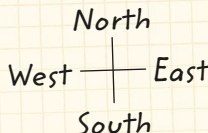
1. Push the stick into the ground. As the Sun shines on the stick, it will make a shadow. Place your stones at the end of the shadow at different times during the day—the first one in the morning and the last one in the afternoon.

2. The stones will make a curve. The north-south line is where the Sun made the shortest shadow. The east-west line cuts at right angles to it.

The shortest shadow points north if you live in the Northern Hemisphere and south if you live in the Southern Hemisphere.



The four main compass points



The north-south line.